



Current world records



Distance	Men	Women
100m	Usain Bolt, Jamaica 9.58 seconds (2009)	Florence Griffith Joyner, US 10.49 seconds (1988)
200m	Usain Bolt, Jamaica 19.19 seconds (2009)	Florence Griffith Joyner, US 21.34 seconds (1988)
400m	Wayde van Niekerk, South Africa 43.03 seconds (2016)	Marita Koch, East Germany 47.60 seconds (1985)
800m	David Rudisha, Kenya 1 minute, 40.91 seconds (2012)	Jarmila Kratochvílová, Czechoslovakia 1 minute, 53.28 seconds (1983)
1,500m	Hicham El Guerrouj, Morocco 3 minutes, 26.00 seconds (1998)	Genzebe Dibaba, Ethiopia 3 minutes, 50.07 seconds (2015)
5,000m	Kenenisa Bekele, Ethiopia 12 minutes, 37.35 seconds (2004)	Tirunesh Dibaba, Ethiopia 14 minutes, 11.15 seconds (2008)
10,000m	Kenenisa Bekele, Ethiopia 26 minutes, 17.53 seconds (2005)	Almaz Ayana, Ethiopia 29 minutes, 17.45 seconds (2016)
Marathon	Eliud Kipchoge, Kenya 2 hours, 1 minute, 39 seconds (2018)	Brigid Kosgei, Kenya 2 hours, 14 minutes, 4 seconds (2019)

1,500m

This race covers three-and-a-quarter laps of a track. The best athletes run the race as a long sprint.



Hicham El Guerrouj

5,000m

This is the shortest long-distance race and covers 12-and-a-half laps of a track.



Kenenisa Bekele

10,000m

Athletes must complete 25 laps of the track. The event has been part of the Olympics for men since 1912. Women have completed in the event since 1988.



Almaz Ayana

Marathon

The marathon is the longest event. Instead of running on a track, athletes race over a road course that is 26.219 miles (42.195km) long.



Brigid Kosgei